traffic for a couple of minutes so that we could get away. Frank, our driver, was great; he put his foot down and, about forty minutes later, we were where we wanted to be: snug, safe and having a cup of tea in Tony and Jackie's front room. We practically lived at the Adams' house until we bought our own place down south a few years ago. And where better for a new mum to rest up than her family home?

The grandparents were smooching over the baby and, for a few minutes, Victoria and I were alone, sipping our tea and looking at one another. I'm sure it's a moment that hits every new mum and dad. This is about as real as life gets, and nobody can tell you what you have to do. You take a deep breath. *Right. What happens now?*

Victoria breastfed for about a month. I'm really protective about my family anyway but, during those first days, watching my wife-to-be and our boy together—her feeding him milk and love—made those feelings more intense than I've ever known. But, fantastic as that was, after a couple of weeks I found myself starting to wonder. *You know what? I want to be able to help feed him too.*

Breastfeeding was really tiring for Victoria, just like it is for every mum, and so she let me go and raid the baby shelves at the pharmacists. I came back with the lot: bottles, warmers, pumps, sterilizers. I must have looked like some kind of mad scientist, setting it all up. I'm glad I did it, though. All the fiddling about to get a bit of Mum's milk into a bottle was worth it: I'll never forget Brooklyn with me on the bed that afternoon: there was my boy, cradled in my arms and glugging away like his life depended on it.

It was an amazing time. Things were so exciting at United and then, every time I could, I'd get down to London to see Victoria and Brooklyn. It was a while before they moved up to be with me at the new flat we'd bought. I didn't overdo the driving, although I've always found being behind the wheel more relaxing than tiring. It's time on my own, after all, and I don't get much of that. Even so, I never made the trip in the couple of days before we had a game. I think some people might have thought it would all be too much, but every time I saw the two most precious people in my life it gave me this amazing lift, like I'd been plugged in to recharge, and I'd go back to Old Trafford ready for more. If anything, what might have dragged me down would have been not being able to spend some time with them both.

Brooklyn's first few months were tough on Victoria. She'd worked so hard for so long with the Spice Girls and had put so much into a successful